VAULTNEURON

The Vault Neuron 15-Point Friction Audit

High-Fidelity Diagnostics for Operational Scale

This audit evaluates the operational systems that power your organization.

By identifying friction across data, workflows, and decision intelligence, leaders can uncover hidden inefficiencies that slow growth.

Vault Neuron

Operational Intelligence Architecture

Why Operational Friction Matters

As companies grow, operational complexity increases. Systems that once worked—manual reporting, disconnected tools, spreadsheet workflows—begin to create friction across teams.

That friction leads to:

- delayed decisions
- duplicated work
- inconsistent data
- leadership blind spots

The Vault Neuron Operational Friction Audit helps identify where those inefficiencies exist and how operational architecture can remove them.

How to Use This Audit

For each statement, answer **YES or NO**.

Add **1 point for each YES response**.

Higher scores indicate greater operational friction.

Data Integrity → **Workflow Velocity** → **Decision Intelligence**

The Vault Neuron Operational Intelligence Model

Pillar 1:

Data Integrity – The Foundation

Reliable operational intelligence begins with reliable data.

When systems are fragmented, automation becomes unreliable and leadership decisions become delayed.

- ❑ **Manual Data Movement**
  Does anyone on your team spend more than **30 minutes per day manually copying data between tools?**
- ❑ **Spreadsheet Version Confusion**
  Are critical decisions being made from spreadsheets labeled **“v2”, “Final”, or “Final_Final”?**
- ❑ **Delayed Financial Visibility**
  Do you need to wait until the **5th of the month or later** to see accurate revenue or expense data from the previous month?
- ❑ **4. Duplicate Customer Records**
  Does the same customer information exist in multiple systems (CRM, email platform, billing software) that are not automatically synchronized?
- ❑ **5. Human Data Cleanup**
  Does someone have to manually clean or format data before leadership can interpret reports?

Pillar 2:

Workflow Velocity – The Operational Engine

Operational workflows determine how quickly a business can move from insight to action.

Manual coordination slows execution and increases operational cost.

- ❑ **Status Meeting Dependency**
  Do you hold meetings primarily to align teams because systems do not provide shared operational visibility?
- ❑ **Approval Bottlenecks**
  Do projects stall for 24+ hours waiting for approvals through email or chat tools?
- ❑ **Client or Project Setup Friction**
  Does it take more than two hours of manual setup to onboard a new client or project?
- ❑ **Lead Response Delay**
  Are inbound inquiries waiting longer than 15 minutes before being automatically routed to the correct person?
- ❑ **Executive Administrative Work**
  Are senior team members performing repetitive administrative tasks that could be automated?

Pillar 3:

Decision Intelligence – Leadership Visibility

The purpose of operational architecture is to enable clear, timely decision-making.

When leaders lack reliable insights, strategy becomes reactive instead of intentional.

- ❑ **Limited Unit Economics Visibility**
  Can you instantly see metrics such as Customer Acquisition Cost vs Lifetime Value, or must this be calculated manually?
- ❑ **No Early Churn Indicators**
  Do you lack systems that identify at-risk customers before churn occurs?
- ❑ **Mobile Visibility Gap**
  Can leadership review key operational metrics from a phone in under 30 seconds?
- ❑ **Report Overload**
  Are reports so dense or complex that they are rarely reviewed?
- ❑ **System Firefighting**
  Do leaders spend more than 20% of their week fixing operational system issues instead of strategic work?

The Operational Friction Score

*Add one point for each **YES** response.*

0-4	Stable Infrastructure	Your systems are functioning efficiently and may be ready for advanced automation and AI augmentation.
5-9	Growth Friction	Your systems are surviving but not scaling. Operational architecture improvements could unlock significant efficiency.
10-15	Operational Fragmentation	Manual processes are compensating for disconnected systems. Structural redesign may be required.

Next Step: Identify the Architecture Behind the Friction

If your organization scored 5 or higher, there are likely opportunities to streamline systems, automate workflows, and improve decision visibility.

Vault Neuron offers a deeper diagnostic called the Infrastructure Friction Audit, which evaluates your operational systems in greater detail.

Run the Infrastructure Friction Audit

Schedule a Blueprint Consultation

Vault Neuron

Operational Intelligence Architecture

This diagnostic is based on the **Vault Neuron Operational Intelligence Model**, which evaluates organization performance across data architecture, workflow design, and decision systems.